

## **COOK COUNTY HEALTH**

Social Work Services

1969 W. Ogden Ave., Chicago, IL 60612

Phone: (312) 555-3800

### **SOCIAL WORK ASSESSMENT**

Patient: Marcus D. Whitfield MRN: PED-2025-04471

DOB: 03/03/2016 Age: 9 years

Date: 02/15/2026 Referral Source: DCFS placement intake

Social Worker: Angela Morris, LCSW

### **ASSESSMENT**

Marcus is a 9-year-old male in DCFS custody, currently in his fourth foster placement in three years. He was placed with Ms. Renee Carter on 02/04/2026 following the disruption of his third placement due to the prior caregiver's health issues. Marcus has a complex medical history requiring coordination across multiple specialty providers. His biological mother, Maria Ruiz, is a Guatemalan immigrant currently uncontactable. There is no known biological father. Parental rights are under review.

### **SOCIAL DETERMINANTS OF HEALTH**

- Housing: Current foster home at 1847 S. Hamlin Ave., Chicago. Built ~1950. No environmental lead inspection has been completed despite documented elevated blood lead levels and pica behavior. DCFS caseworker has been notified of the need for an inspection.
- Food security: Ms. Carter reports adequate food access. Marcus has limited food preferences consistent with ASD-related sensory processing. Caloric intake likely suboptimal.
- Education: Enrolled at Lincoln Elementary, 4th grade, approximately 2 weeks. IEP from Roosevelt Elementary has not been transferred. Marcus currently receives no special education accommodations at Lincoln.
- Insurance: Medicaid, DCFS Foster Care (Illinois). Active.
- Transportation: Ms. Carter has personal vehicle. No transportation barriers identified.
- Legal: DCFS case open. Parental rights review pending. No current visitation orders.
- Domestic violence exposure: DCFS records document that Marcus was exposed to domestic violence in the biological home prior to removal. His biological mother, Maria Ruiz, was identified as a victim of domestic violence. Marcus witnessed multiple incidents per DCFS intake documentation. This history is relevant to his PTSD diagnosis and behavioral presentation.
- Dental: No dental examination documented across any of the four foster placements. This constitutes a gap in DCFS-mandated health screening.
- Behavioral health: Marcus has a history of three psychiatric hospitalizations for self-injurious behavior. He is followed by Dr. Osei (Psychiatry) and Dr. Liang (Dev Peds). Current behavioral health services are limited to medication management; no active ABA or therapy services in place.
- Pica / lead exposure: Marcus has documented pica behavior and rising blood lead levels. Ms. Carter reports that Marcus is highly attached to a set of painted wooden toys from his biological home, which he frequently mouths during periods of stress. The toys have not been tested for lead content. Environmental lead inspection of the current foster home has not been completed.

### **PLAN**

- Coordinate with DCFS for environmental lead inspection of current foster home.
- Coordinate dental appointment.
- Coordinate IEP transfer to Lincoln Elementary per IDEA 30-day requirement.
- Follow up with Ms. Carter in 2 weeks regarding adjustment and service coordination.

Angela Morris, LCSW

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Electronically signed: 02/15/2026

Dictated and finalized on 02/15/2026